INCH-POUND

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

STANDARD PRACTICE

PROVISIONS FOR EVALUATING QUALITY OF MEN'S SHIRTS

AMSC N/A FSC 8405

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FOREWORD

1. This standard is approved for use by the Department of the Army and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

2. This standard is intended to provide standard practice for quality inspections of men's shirts. This standard provides the following information:

- A standard method for visually inspecting and evaluating the quality of shirts
- Standard descriptions for shirts defects
- Standardized examination requirements for shirts

3. Shirts covered by this document are designated as Dress, Semi-Dress and Utility. Semi-dress shirts are sometimes referred to as "Service Uniform" shirts. If an end-item specification includes a list of defects or exceptions to this standard, the end-item specification will prevail.

4. Comments, suggestions or questions on this document should be addressed to: Attn: DLA Troop Support, 700 Robbins Street, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This standard covers the inspection provisions requirements for shirts worn by members of the military.

1.2 Purpose. The purpose of this document is to provide standardized examination provisions for evaluating the quality of shirts. It is intended to, in a single document, list defects irrespective of fabrics used.

1.3 Applicability. This standard is applicable to contracts by reference in the appropriate shirts specifications.

1.4 Classification. The shirts will be of the following types:

Dress
Semi-Dress
Utility

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3, 4 or 5 of this standard. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this standard or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3, 4 and 5 of this standard, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents. No Government documents are currently specified in this standard.

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS

68373A: AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales

(Scales are available at https://www.aatcc.org)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY

ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of this document are available online at https://www.asq.org.)

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ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM D3990 - Standard Terminology Relating to Fabric Defects
ASTM D6193 - Standard Practice for Stitches and Seams

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org.)

Fabric Defect Replica Scales

(For information on obtaining copies of the Fabric Defect Replica Scales please contact U.S. Army Combat Capabilities Development Command (CCDC), Soldier Center, ATTN: FCDD-SCD-PE, 10 General Greene Avenue, Natick, MA 01760-5019.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document or end-item specific documents, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations, unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. DEFINITIONS

3.1 Defective button. A button will be considered defective when it is broken or cracked; has sharp, rough or split edges; has scratches or dents, blemishes or foreign matter embedded or is unevenly shaded. Additional button defects may be found in the defects tables in section 5 of this standard or in applicable button specifications.

3.2 End-item. End-item refers to finished shirts ready for inspection and acceptance.

3.3 Fabric defects. Fabric defects specified in Table I are defined in ASTM D3990. Fabric defects not specified in Table I are specified in the appropriate fabric specification.

3.4 Inside and outside. The term “inside” refers to any part of the shirt that is not visible when completely closed and fastened, while the term “outside” refers to any part of the shirt that is visible when the completely closed and fastened.

3.5 Knots and slubs. Only knots and slubs on the outside of the shirts that exceed the limits in the basic cloth specification will be scored as defects in evaluating quality of the finished shirts. Knots and slubs are rated using Fabric Defect Replica Scales (see 2.3).

3.6 Major defect. A departure of a quality characteristic from its intended level of the specification that occurs with a severity sufficient that is likely to result in a failure, or to reduce considerably the usability of shirts for its intended purpose.

3.7 Minor defect. A departure of a quality characteristic from its intended level of the specification but the shirts are still considered serviceable. (Multiple minor defects may render shirts or production lot unserviceable).

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3.8 Puckering. Refers to the gathering of a seam/stitches during sewing, after sewing and after laundering causing unacceptable seam appearance when compared to the AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales (see 2.3). Puckering on major portions of the suspected seam that has a rating less than "4" will be scored as a puckered seam.

3.9 Quality assurance terms and procedures. Definitions of quality assurance terms and procedures, where applicable, will be in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4.

3.10 Raw edge. Raw edge is defined as any fabric edge not serged or otherwise finished to prevent raveling.

3.11 Seams and stitching. Unless otherwise specified, seams and stitching will be as defined in ASTM D6193. Open seam defects will be as defined in 3.11.1.

3.11.1 Open seam. A seam will be considered open when stitching joining the seam area are broken, skipped or missing stitches. (Seams with multiple rows of stitching are considered open when any of the criteria in this section are met by any one or more of the rows.)

3.12 Shirt. The term "shirt" means "an outer garment covering the upper body from the waist to the neck, with a separate part for each arm". While this standard is focused on shirts worn by men, it may also be used for the evaluation of items meeting this description that are worn by women.

4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 General. This standard contains provisions and terminology for end-item inspection of dress, semi-dress and utility shirts. If there are any inconsistencies between the requirements of the appropriate end-item specification and the provisions of this standard, the end-item specification shall govern.

4.2 Normal viewing conditions. Normal viewing conditions for the inspection of shirts is three (3) feet from the surface being examined. Unless otherwise specified, shirts shall be examined while laid flat on a suitable table using the following illumination criteria. The overhead direct lighting source shall be parallel to the viewing surface so as to illuminate with direct perpendicular impinging light rays. The surface illumination level shall be a minimum of 1075 lux (100 foot candles). The lights shall be cool white preheat rapid start fluorescent lamps with white reflectors and without baffles or glass.

5. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Sampling and acceptance criteria. The sample unit shall be one finished shirt and lot size shall be expressed in the number of sample units. The sample size and Acceptance Quality Limits (AQLs) shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. Sampling shall represent all types, classes, and styles included in the

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production lot, and shall include samples from the beginning, middle and end of production of the end specification.

5.2 End-item dimensional examination. Finished shirts shall be measured for conformance to the finished measurements as stated in the end item specification. The sample size for end item dimensional examination shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 End-item visual examination. The shirts shall be examined for the defects stated in Table I of this document. Defects are assigned as “Major” or “Minor”. The sample unit shall be one finished shirt.

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TABLE I. End-item defects.

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
I. MATERIAL DEFECT AND DAMAGE:						
Any hole, cut, tear, smash, burn, drill hole, scorched area and/or multiple float:						
- Up to ¼-inch, inclusive	101		101			201
- More than ¼-inch in any direction	102		102		101	
Any knot and/or slub 1/		201		201		202
Misweave, area of poor/no dye (print) penetration, dye streak, missing yarn, broken yarn, visible mend, thin place, shade bar and barre		202		202		203
Loose yarn, snag and/or coarse yarn more than ½-inch in any direction on outside	103			203		204
Woven in debris and/or waste on outside visible at 3-feet		203		204		205
II. SHADED PARTS						
Variation and shade within a part and/or between parts	104		103			206
III. STITCHING AND SEAM DEFECTS						
Needle chew:						
- Up to ¼-inch, inclusive, in any direction		204		205		207
- More than ¼-inch in any direction	105		104		102	
Seam allowance not as specified		205		206		208
Raw edge of fabric not as specified (except where pinking is required)		206		207		209
Seams irregular, twisted, wavy and/or pleated	106			208		210
Wrong seam and/or stitch type	107		105		103	

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
III. STITCHING AND SEAM DEFECTS (continued)						
Any line of stitching omitted	108		106		104	
Any line of stitching not starting and/or ending where specified		207		209		211
Basting stitch visible on outside of the finished shirts		208		210		212
Gauge irregular and/or not within range specified (score only when condition exists on more than ½-inch the length of the seam)		209		211		213
Stitches per inch incorrect		210		212		214
Loose stitch tension:						
- Up to ½-inch inclusive		211		213		215
- More than ¾-inch	109		107		105	
Tight stitch tension (all seams)	110		108		106	
Seam puckered 2/ (score only on major portion of seam)	111		109			216
Any part of shirt caught in an unrelated operation and/or stitching	112		110		107	
End of stitching, when not caught in another seam, not backstitched as specified		212		214		217
Thread break not repaired by backstitching at least ½-inch		213		215		218
Ends of a continuous line of stitching not overlapped by at least ½-inch		214		216		219
Open seam (see 3.11.1) and/or runoff:						
- Up to and including ½-inch		215		217		220
- Greater than ½-inch	113		111		108	

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
III. STITCHING AND SEAM DEFECTS (continued)						
Seams not lapped as specified	114		112		109	
Pleated and/or twisted at base of pocket opening and/or flap	115		113			221
IV. COMPONENTS						
Any component omitted and/or part not as specified and/or twisted, unless otherwise specified below	116		114		110	
Thread/gimp						
Thread/gimp color not as specified	117		115			222
Button						
Button not as specified, broken, cracked, bent		216		218		223
Collar stays						
Collar stays, missing, not as specified	118		116		--	--
Binding						
Not as specified		217		219		224
Not cut as specified (e.g. not on bias)		218		220		225
Width of finished binding not as specified		219		221		226
Fusing material (when applicable)						
Not as specified	119		117		--	--
Hook and loop fastener						
Not as specified	--	--	--	--	111	
Non-functioning	--	--	--	--	112	
Label						
Not as specified (material)		220		222		227
Missing, incorrect and/or illegible information	120		118		113	

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION						
Unless otherwise specified, items intended to be equal in length and or in alignment that differ by more than ½-inch and ⅛-inch respectively.	121		119		114	
Any component part not cut and/or sewn in accordance with specified directional lines, twill lines and/or fabric grain not parallel between parts	122		120		115	
Excessive bulging, twisting, pulling and/or puckering at closures (buttons) are properly positioned according to marks on patterns	123		121		116	
Notch exposed at pocket opening	124		122		117	
Buttonhole						
Not as specified, misplaced, omitted, added, not finished as specified	125		123		118	
Gimp omitted, uncut buttonhole, incomplete stitching	126		124		119	
Two (2) or more skipped, broken and/or loose stitches		221		223		228
Finished cut length not as specified		222		224		229
Two (2) and/or more uncut yarns in buttonhole not caught in overcast stitching)		223		225		230
Button						
Misplaced, missing, insecurely and/or improperly sewn		224		226		231
Location not as specified		225		227		232
Number of buttons not as specified		226		228		233
Shank wrapping (when required omitted and/or loosely wrapped)	--	--	--	--		234

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (continued)						
Button (continued)						
Stitching on one and/or more not locked at end of cycle (tug at the loose end of the thread when accessible to determine if it will ravel)		227		229		235
Bartack or tack						
Missing, insecure, misplaced, not serving intended purpose and/or not specified size and/or type:						
- Bartack for attachment	127		125		120	
- Bartack for reinforcement		228		230		235
Incorrect number of stitches		229		231		236
Loose and/or tight stitch tension		230		232		237
Collar						
Not uniform in size and shape, not as specified:						
- More than 3/8-inch with corresponding point on matching part	128		126		121	
- ¼-inch up to and including 3/8-inch with corresponding point on matching part	129		127			238
Collar point uneven in length by:						
- 1/8-inch up to and including ¼ inch		231		233	--	--
- More than ¼-inch up to and including 3/8-inch	130		128			239
Twisted, not smooth, too full, short and/or tight causing collar to turn out	131		129		122	
Collar point not properly forced out	132		130		123	
Collar stays missing	133		131		--	--

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (continued)						
Collar (continued)						
Special slotted stays improperly positioned		232		234	--	--
Collar off center, causing puckers and/or pleats at neckline		233		235		240
One and/or both stays not fitted into point of collar within ¼-inch of edge stitching at the point	134			236	--	--
End of collar stand finished more than 1/8-inch beyond front edge	135		132		--	--
Collar ends open less than ¼-inch and/or open more than ¾-inch when buttoned	136		133		--	--
One and/or both collar stays not spot laminated at both ends of stay (if laminated stays are used)		234		237	--	--
Edge of undercollar exposed beyond edge of top collar:						
- 1/16-inch and/or more for a distance of 2-inches or more	137		134			241
Shoulder loop						
Not uniform in size and shape, not as specified:						
- More than 3/8-inch with corresponding point on matching part	138		135		124	
- ¼ inch up to and including 3/8-inch with corresponding point on matching part		235		238		242
Not positioned as specified and/or attached crookedly	139		136			243
Loop tight, loose and/or badly distorted when buttoned	140		137			244
Front						
Spacing between two and/or more buttonholes unequal by ¼-inch or more	141			239		245
Buttonhole out of alignment by 1/8-inch		236		240		246

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (continued)						
Front (continued):						
Front tight and/or short and/or front facing tight and/or twisted causing noticeable bulge and/or twist when shirt is buttoned	142		138			247
Lapel step more than 1-1/2 inches and/or less than ¾-inch wide, and/or width of steps uneven by more than ¼-inch	143			241	--	--
Uneven in length at bottom when buttoned by more than ½-inch		237		242		248
Buttons out vertical alignment by more than ¼-inch	144		139			249
Buttonholes are out of alignment with corresponding buttons by more than ¼-inch		238		243		250
Front facing:						
Facing not as specified		239		244		251
Width of facing not as specified		240		245		252
Facing not smooth and flat, shows evidence of puckering	145			246		253
Pocket or flap:						
Not uniform in size and/or shape up to 3/8-inch	146		140		125	
Pocket and/or flap out of alignment from each other by more than 1/4-inch when intended to be in corresponding locations	147		141		126	
Pocket and pocket flap not constructed as specified	148		142		127	
Poor pocket construction causing fullness and/or distortion		241		247		254
Pocket edge not parallel to front edge of shirt (when applicable) up to ¼-inch	149		143		128	
Pocket and/or pocket flap width and/or depth not as specified		242		248		255
Pocket flap not as specified, crooked, poorly shaped and/or constructed, not covering pocket opening	150		144			256

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. Construction (continued)						
Pocket or flap (continued):						
Pocket flap not properly forced out	151		145			257
Edge of under flap exposed beyond edge of top flap by more than ¼-inch	152		146			258
Side edge(s) of flap extending beyond side edge(s) of pocket by more than ¼-inch	153		147			259
Pocket exposed beyond end of flap by 1/8-inch and/or more		243		249		260
Pocket opening gapped	154		148			261
Pencil pocket omitted, not constructed as specified and/or not positioned as specified		244		250		262
Pocket hem not as specified		245		251		263
Corner of pencil pocket not securely tacked		246		252		264
Upper sleeve pocket:						
- Pocket omitted and/or size not as specified	--	--	--	--	129	
- Pocket bellows constructed not as specified	--	--	--	--	130	
- Pocket eyelets missing or not as specified	--	--	--	--		265
- Pocket and pocket flap loop tape missing or not stitched as specified	--	--	--	--	131	
Armhole and sleeve:						
Sleeves not attached as specified, reversed	155		149		132	
Sleeves tight causing pleat and/or excessive puckers on front, back and/or sleeve	--	--	150		133	
Construction of sleeve opening:						
- End of binding not securely caught in sleeve opening i.e. can be easily pulled away	--	--	151		134	
Binding not the correct width and not attached as specified	156		152			266

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. Construction (continued)						
Armhole and sleeve (continued)						
Binding twisted and/or puckered		247		253		267
Placket length varies in length by more than ½-inch		248		254	--	--
Sides of opening uneven in length in by ¼-inch and/or more (measured to top edge of cuff)		249		255		268
Cuff (s)						
Reversed (i.e. buttonhole on underside and button on top side)	157		153		135	
Cuffs not as specified, irregular in width, width less than specified		250		256		269
End of cuff finished beyond outer edge of sleeve opening by more than 3/16 inch		251		257		270
Buttonholes on cuff misplaced and/or not positioned as specified; out of alignment with other buttonholes resulting in bulge and/or twist on cuff when worn, applicable to French-style (four buttonhole) cuff only	158		--	--	--	--
Edge of stitching on cuff not as specified		252		258		271
Yoke						
Yoke and back not lapped as specified		253		259		272
Center plait						
Width not as specified		254		260	--	--
Irregular in width (varies more than ¼-inch)		255		261	--	--
Front edge of plait extending beyond front edge of left front less than 1/8-inch and/or more than ¼-inch		256		262	--	--

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. Construction (continued)						
Bottom hem and sleeve hem						
Width not as specified		257		263		273
Irregular in width (varies more than ¼-inch)		258		264		274
Hem end extending more than 1/8 inch beyond front edge of shirt		259		265		275
Hem twisted, pleated and/or puckered		260		266		276
Hook and loop:						
Omitted	--	--	--	--	136	
Hook and loop on wrong sleeve and wrong front side and not positioned properly	--	--	--	--	137	
Hook and loop not stitched correctly	--	--	--	--		277
Fusible:						
Omitted	159		154			278
Applied in incorrect locations (i.e. to underflap instead of top flap as required)	160		155			279
Evidence of bleed through, delamination, bubbling and/or color change	161		156			280
Twisted causing puckers and/or pleats outside of shirt	162		157			281
Label						
Not as specified, missing, incorrect and/or illegible	163		158		138	
VI. PRESSING AND CLEANING EFFECTS						
Pressing omitted and/or poorly pressed, and/or exhibiting a double crease line:						
- On permanent crease and/or durable press	164		159		139	
- On other than permanent crease and/or durable press	165			267		282

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Defect Category					
	Dress		Semi-Dress		Utility	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
VI. PRESSING AND CLEANING EFFECTS (continued)						
Pressing not seam on seam by more than ½-inch:						
- On permanent crease and/or durable press	166			268		283
- On other than permanent crease and/or durable press		261		269		284
Permanent crease omitted:						
≥1-inch	167		160			285
Permanent crease line not ending within specified limits	168		161			286
Seam allowance not pressed open (if applicable)		262		270	--	--
Burned and/or scorched in pressing	169		162			287
Gloss and/or impressions not removed		263		271	--	--
Any spot and/or stain that cannot be completely removed with a clean cloth moistened with water:						
- 1/16-inch to ⅜-inch, inclusive		264		272		288
- >⅜-inch up to and including ¾-inch	170		163			289
Three (3) or more thread ends on the outside greater than and/or equal to ½-inch		265		273		290
Re-sewn and/or re-stitched seams not cleaned	171		164			291
Thread end caught in a line of stitching on the outside for more than ¼-inch		266		274		292

1/ Knots and slubs shall be rated in accordance with the Fabric Defect Replica Scales.
2/ Puckering shall be rated in accordance with the AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales (see 2.3). Puckering on major portions of the suspected seam that has a rating less than “4” shall be scored as a puckered seam.

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5.4 Shade variation examination. During the examination, each shirt in the sample shall be examined for shade variation. Any shirt in the sample containing uneven shade or shade variation, within a part or between parts, shall be cause for rejection of entire lot represented by the sample.

5.4.1 Shade match and appearance examination. The shade match and appearance examination shall be conducted as specified in the end-item specification, contract or purchase order.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. To provide a standardized examination procedure for evaluating quality of men's shirts that are worn by members of the military as part of dress, semi-dress and utility uniforms. These defects are typical of those included in quality inspections of shirts.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this standard
b. Type of material defects allowed.
c. The specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.3)
d. Acceptance Quality Levels (AQLs)
e. Sample size

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Defect
Dress uniform
Examination
Inspection
Semi-Dress uniform
Utility uniform

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

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Custodians:
Army – GL
Navy – NU
Air Force – 11

Preparing activity:
DLA - CT

(Project 8405- 2021-004)

Review activities:
Navy – MC, CG1

Civil agencies:
GSA – FAS

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using ASSIST online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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